Julian Pacheco

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Background

Biomedical researcher with over four years of experience in HIV immunology and nonhuman primate models at OHSU's Vaccine and Gene Therapy Institute. Working across academic, clinical, and international research collaborations taught me the value of combining diverse perspectives to solve complex scientific problems. My growing interest in analytics and data-driven discovery led me to pursue a master's degree in data science at Willamette University. Today, my interests lie at the intersection of biology, data science, and machine learning, where I hope to leverage computational approaches to accelerate discovery and translate complex data into meaningful impact.

Education

Willamette University — Salem, OR
M.S. in Data Science — August 2026

Portland State University — Portland, OR
B.S. in Biology — June 2017

Scientific Research Experience

Vaccine & Gene Therapy Institute (OHSU) — Beaverton, OR
Research Assistant — 2021-Present

- Generated and analyzed high-dimensional immunology datasets from human and non-human primate studies, developing analytical workflows for multi-parameter flow cytometry and longitudinal immune monitoring.
- Produced and integrated longitudinal datasets spanning flow cytometry, viral load, cytokine, and molecular assays to investigate treatment response, immune function, and viral reservoir dynamics.
- Collaborated across multidisciplinary research teams to transform complex biological data into scientific findings, therapeutic insights, and evidence supporting translational research programs.

Bureau of Land Management — Lakeview, OR
Biological Field Technician (Contract) — 2020

- Generated and curated ecological and wildlife monitoring datasets for a multi-year restoration study evaluating sagebrush ecosystem recovery following juniper removal.
- Integrated geospatial, telemetry, vegetation, and environmental data to assess habitat utilization patterns and ecosystem response to land-management interventions.
- Contributed to research findings that informed conservation policy and land-management decisions, supporting peer-reviewed publication and stakeholder recommendations.

Research & Publications

Peer Reviewed Articles

Hiroshi Takata, Julie L. Mitchell, **Julian Pacheco**, et al, (2023) *"An active HIV reservoir during ART is associated with maintenance of HIV specific CD8+ T cell magnitude and short lived differentiation status",* Cell Host & Microbe, Volume 31, Issue 9, 1494 - 1506.e4.

Conference Posters

Yanhui Cai, Hiroshi Takata, Anne Maud Ferreira, **Julian Pacheco Mendez**, et al, *"HIV Specific T Cell Responses in Suppressed People with HIV-1 Receiving Lenacapavir, Teropavimab, and Zinlirvimab",* Oral presentation (Gilead Sciences collaboration) at the IAS 2025 – 13th IAS Conference on HIV Science, Kigali, Rwanda, July 2025. Presentation #OAA0205.

Hiroshi Takata, **Julian Pacheco**, et al, *"RV550: IL-15 Superagonist N-803 With ART in Acute HIV Infection Enhances T and NK Cell Proliferation",* Poster presented at the Conference on Retroviruses and Opportunistic Infections, San Francisco, CA, March 2025.

Hiroshi Takata, **Julian Pacheco**, et al, *"RV550: IL-15 Superagonist N-803 at ART Interruption Enhances NK and T Cell Proliferation and Activation Prior to Viral Rebound",* Poster presented at Keystone Symposia - HIV Persistence, Remission, and Cure, Breckenridge, CO, April 2026.

Benjamin Varco Merth, Alejandra Marino, Hiroshi Takata, **Julian Pacheco**, et al, *"IL-15 Superagonist at ART Initiation Expands SIV Specific CD8+ T Cells in Blood and Lymphoid Tissues",* Poster #309 presented at the Conference on Retroviruses and Opportunistic Infections, San Francisco, CA, March 2025.

Hiroshi Takata, **Julian Pacheco**, et al, *"RV550: IL-15 Superagonist N-803 with ART in Acute HIV Infection Enhances T and NK Cell Proliferation",* Poster #0444 presented at the Conference on Retroviruses and Opportunistic Infections, San Francisco, CA, March 2025.

Julie Mitchell, Caroline Subra, **A. Julian Pacheco Mendez**, et al, *"Compartmentalized Clonal Expansions of CD8+ T Cells in CSF During Acute HIV Infection",* Poster presented at the Conference on Retroviruses and Opportunistic Infections (Virtual), April 2023.